Answer key

SAT Practice Test 1, Reading and Writing

Module 1

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	**B**	Words in context
2	**A**	Words in context
3	**C**	Words in context
4	**D**	Words in context
5	**A**	Words in context
6	**C**	Text structure and purpose
7	**D**	Text structure and purpose
8	**A**	Text structure and purpose
9	**B**	Cross-text connections
10	**A**	Central ideas and details
11	**C**	Central ideas and details
12	**A**	Inferences
13	**D**	Inferences
14	**D**	Command of evidence: textual
15	**C**	Command of evidence: textual
16	**B**	Command of evidence: textual
17	**B**	Command of evidence: quantitative
18	**A**	Command of evidence: quantitative
19	**C**	Boundaries
20	**B**	Form, structure, and sense
21	**D**	Form, structure, and sense
22	**B**	Form, structure, and sense
23	**A**	Form, structure, and sense
24	**A**	Boundaries
25	**C**	Boundaries
26	**A**	Form, structure, and sense
27	**D**	Transitions
28	**B**	Transitions
29	**A**	Transitions
30	**C**	Rhetorical synthesis
31	**A**	Rhetorical synthesis
32	**C**	Rhetorical synthesis
33	**D**	Rhetorical synthesis

Module 2

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	**B**	Words in context
2	**D**	Words in context
3	**A**	Words in context
4	**C**	Words in context
5	**B**	Words in context
6	**D**	Text structure and purpose
7	**C**	Text structure and purpose
8	**A**	Text structure and purpose
9	**D**	Cross-text connections
10	**B**	Central ideas and details
11	**A**	Central ideas and details
12	**C**	Command of evidence: quantitative
13	**D**	Command of evidence: quantitative
14	**A**	Command of evidence: textual
15	**C**	Command of evidence: textual
16	**B**	Command of evidence: textual
17	**C**	Inferences
18	**B**	Inferences
19	**A**	Inferences
20	**D**	Form, structure, and sense
21	**D**	Boundaries
22	**A**	Form, structure, and sense
23	**B**	Form, structure, and sense
24	**C**	Boundaries
25	**D**	Boundaries
26	**A**	Form, structure, and sense
27	**C**	Transitions
28	**B**	Transitions
29	**A**	Transitions
30	**B**	Rhetorical synthesis
31	**D**	Rhetorical synthesis
32	**C**	Rhetorical synthesis
33	**A**	Transitions

Answer key

SAT Practice Test 1, Math

Module 1

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	**B**	Data analysis
2	**B**	Percentages
3	**C**	Linear equations
4	**A**	Linear equations in context
5	**C**	Systems of equations
6	**D**	Functions
7	**B**	Nonlinear expressions
8	**A**	Ratios and rates
9	**C**	Triangles
10	**B**	Circles
11	**A**	Quadratics
12	**D**	Probability
13	**B**	Statistics
14	**C**	Scatterplots
15	**A**	Inequalities
16	**D**	Functions
17	**B**	Exponential functions
18	**B**	Systems of equations in context
19	**C**	Radicals
20	**A**	Linear functions
21	**28**	Linear equations
22	**63**	Area
23	**5**	Linear equations
24	**30**	Percent change
25	**8**	Quadratics
26	**90**	Volume
27	**12**	Right triangles

Module 2

NO.	ANSWER	SKILL
1	**D**	Functions
2	**A**	Systems of equations
3	**C**	Quadratics
4	**B**	Percentages
5	**D**	Exponential functions
6	**C**	Linear functions
7	**A**	Scatterplots
8	**B**	Circles in the plane
9	**A**	Quadratics
10	**C**	Functions
11	**D**	Systems of equations
12	**B**	Surface area
13	**A**	Circles
14	**C**	Trigonometry
15	**D**	Percentages
16	**B**	Absolute value
17	**D**	Exponential equations
18	**B**	Percentages
19	**C**	Exponential functions
20	**A**	Statistics
21	**22**	Systems of equations
22	**4**	Quadratics
23	**40**	Similar triangles
24	**4**	Circles in the plane
25	**26**	Quadratics
26	**10**	Quadratics
27	**8**	Systems with nonlinear equations

Score yourself. Count the questions you got right in each module.

Reading and Writing, Module 1: ___ of 33

Module 2: ___ of 33

Math, Module 1: ___ of 27

Module 2: ___ of 27

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Reading and Writing, Module 1

Questions 1 to 17

1 **Choice B** Words in context

The colon explains the blank: the light draws smaller fish close. To attract is to draw something near. Repel is the reverse, and the lure is not described as copying or hiding anything.

2 **Choice A** Words in context

Readers who gave up on the book found the timelines more of a burden than a pleasure. Disorienting fits; engaging and predictable would not lead readers to abandon the book.

3 **Choice C** Words in context

The sentence contrasts decorative with something that does a job, and the colon names the job: strengthening social ties. Functional is the only choice that makes that contrast.

4 **Choice D** Words in context

Even though introduces a contrast with the cheaper option of modern pigments, so the curators kept the original colours. Preserve means to keep unchanged.

5 **Choice A** Words in context

After the colon, the mayor takes no side, which is what noncommittal means. Enthusiastic and hostile both imply a clear position.

6 **Choice C** Text structure and purpose

Odile says the job is temporary, yet the final sentence reveals she would be sorry to give it up. That tension is the point of the passage. Nothing suggests resentment, and the lamps are background, not the subject.

7 **Choice D** Text structure and purpose

The first four lines catalogue sounds. The turn at "But here" reveals comfort instead of annoyance. No past event, complaint or questions appear.

8 **Choice A** Text structure and purpose

The sentence gives a specific failure, and the next sentence begins with Since then to show that wind tunnel testing followed from it. The passage treats wind as a real threat and mentions no disagreement.

9 **Choice B** Cross-text connections

The Text 2 researcher found remote work lowered output for teams that rely on unplanned conversation, so the general claim misses those cases. The researcher does not dispute that people feel less distracted.

10 **Choice A** Central ideas and details

The passage overturns the mating explanation and replaces it with a warning function. The other choices state things the text never claims, and one reverses its findings.

11 **Choice C** Central ideas and details

Marcus expects the cafeteria to be something to endure, yet the silence he shares does not feel like loneliness. He is surprised, not resentful, and no invitation or decision to leave appears.

12 **Choice A** Inferences

If the originals depend on gestures and taste, a written record without quantities can only come close. The other choices contradict the logic of the passage.

13 **Choice D** Inferences

If the necks were held low, reaching treetops cannot have been their only job, so another purpose is likely. The analysis says nothing about diet, movement or how often bones are found.

14 **Choice D** Command of evidence: textual

Removing otters and seeing urchins rise and kelp fall tests the chain Ferrante proposes. The other findings do not connect otters to kelp through urchins.

15 **Choice C** Command of evidence: textual

Dara says she is fine, but her harder and harder placing of the chairs shows what she feels. In the other choices, feelings are stated outright or not shown at all.

16 **Choice B** Command of evidence: textual

If openings doubled everywhere, the subway is unlikely to be the cause. The other findings leave the link between the line and the openings untouched or even strengthen it.

17 **Choice B** Command of evidence: quantitative

The lowest bar is the 12 to 17 group, at about 410. The other choices name groups with higher bars.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Reading and Writing, Module 1

Questions 18 to 33

18 **Choice A** **Command of evidence: quantitative**

Granny Smith is lowest for sweetness yet highest for crispness, so the two do not move together. The other choices either do not compare the two ratings or show them rising together.

19 **Choice C** **Boundaries**

Two complete sentences cannot be joined by a comma alone or with no punctuation. A semicolon joins them correctly. A semicolon followed by and is not standard.

20 **Choice B** **Form, structure, and sense**

The subject is the singular collection, not the plural word soldiers in the phrase after it, so the verb must be singular and present: is.

21 **Choice D** **Form, structure, and sense**

The collecting was completed before another past event (the festival ending), which calls for the past perfect: had collected.

22 **Choice B** **Form, structure, and sense**

The proposals belong to the two boards, a plural noun, so the plural possessive boards' is needed. Board's would belong to a single board.

23 **Choice A** **Form, structure, and sense**

An opening phrase must be followed by the person or thing doing the walking. Only we can walk along the shoreline; the other choices leave the phrase attached to the wrong noun.

24 **Choice A** **Boundaries**

The phrase a plant native to alpine meadows is extra information about the edelweiss, so it must be set off by a pair of commas, one before and one after.

25 **Choice C** **Boundaries**

A complete sentence followed by a list that explains it takes a colon. A comma or no mark would blur the boundary, and a semicolon is used between independent clauses.

26 **Choice A** **Form, structure, and sense**

The possessive pronoun its needs no apostrophe. It's means it is, and the other forms are not standard.

27 **Choice D** **Transitions**

The failure would normally discourage her, but she kept going, which is a contrast. Nevertheless signals that contrast.

28 **Choice B** **Transitions**

The second sentence adds a further benefit to the first, so an additive transition such as Moreover fits. However and Instead would signal a contrast.

29 **Choice A** **Transitions**

Mirrors were introduced in response to the blurring described in the first sentence. To address this problem links the two ideas.

30 **Choice C** **Rhetorical synthesis**

The goal is size, and the length and the count of individual reefs are the size facts in the notes. The other choices give a date, a location, or a claim not in the notes.

31 **Choice A** **Rhetorical synthesis**

The audience already knows the author, so the best choice names the book and says what it covers. The others either re-introduce the author or leave out the title.

32 **Choice C** **Rhetorical synthesis**

The goal is significance, and only the correct choice says why the notes matter: they contain what many consider the first published computer program. The others give dates or a bare description.

33 **Choice D** **Rhetorical synthesis**

Only the first choice compares the lengths of the main spans, which is the size difference. One choice compares opening dates, and the others state similarities.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Reading and Writing, Module 2

Questions 1 to 17

1 **Choice B** Words in context

The word despite signals a contrast with the guarded final report, so the earlier praise must have been warm and unrestrained. Effusive means that. The other three describe praise that is weak or reluctant, which would not contrast with a cautious report.

2 **Choice D** Words in context

The historians quoted the diary freely and its authority was questioned only after the discovery, so they had treated it as trustworthy. Reliable fits. A source thought controversial or negligible would not have been quoted freely.

3 **Choice A** Words in context

The colon introduces a long list of details recorded for each specimen, which shows thoroughness. Brevity is the opposite, and nothing in the list suggests ambiguity or an informal tone.

4 **Choice C** Words in context

A lake whose chemistry barely shifts, even in a drought, is stable. Volatile means the reverse, and porous and scarce do not describe chemical balance.

5 **Choice B** Words in context

Compliments buried under qualifications leave the verdict unclear, which is what equivocal means. Rapturous would mean unreserved praise, and unflinching suggests a bold, direct judgement.

6 **Choice D** Text structure and purpose

The underlined sentence rejects the idea that the flourishes were mere decoration and the next sentence says what they show about mapmakers' attitudes. It does not concede that they were ornament, offer a counterexample, or discuss survey methods.

7 **Choice C** Text structure and purpose

The quick packing and the idea that the room feels like an accusation show Ansel's unease at how little there is to carry. The text gives no reason for the move, no change of mind and no suggestion that anyone else values his things.

8 **Choice A** Text structure and purpose

The first stanza recalls the father's confident knowledge, the second admits the speaker sees no pattern now, and the closing lines note an instinct that persists. No argument, narrative moral or comparison of places appears.

9 **Choice D** Cross-text connections

Text 2 finds that home use between generations, not economic incentive, best predicts survival, so the sociolinguist would say Text 1 underrates the family. The sociolinguist does not rule out schooling or claim that small communities cannot succeed.

10 **Choice B** Central ideas and details

The text rejects the older idea that pigment simply wore away and proposes that switching it off saves energy and so is an advantage. The genes remain intact, and nothing compares cave fish with other fish as study subjects or calls pigment the costliest process.

11 **Choice A** Central ideas and details

The text argues that circulation counts only books leaving and misses the other uses of the building. It does not recommend ending lending, says nothing about most visitors reading newspapers, and says the library may be busier, not quieter.

12 **Choice C** Command of evidence: quantitative

The graph shows the count at 452 in 2021 and 610 in 2023. The rise is 158, which is about 35 percent of 452, so the sharp rise is correct. The other choices misstate the size of the change, its direction, or the years.

13 **Choice D** Command of evidence: quantitative

The claim needs a rise among nearby students and no rise among those farther away. Only the first choice gives both. One choice shows both groups rising, one reverses the direction, and the last compares the groups at a single point rather than over time.

14 **Choice A** Command of evidence: textual

The claim is about a contrast between early and late work, and only the quotation about abandoning the domestic scale states that contrast directly. The others describe the early reputation or a detail of one late scene without contrasting the two.

15 **Choice C** Command of evidence: textual

The claim concerns flying without rest for over a week, and a recorded eleven days with no landing supports it directly. Distance, weight change and shared routes do not show that the bird never stopped.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Reading and Writing, Module 2

Questions 18 to 33

18 Choice B Inferences

If wider roads simply attract more traffic, adding capacity will not cure congestion, and giving people other ways to travel is the logical remedy. The text does not recommend removing roads, and wider roads increased driving rather than lowering it.

19 Choice A Inferences

Aubert does not decide an interpretation in advance and her performances differ widely, so she treats each as something that forms in the moment. The text does not mention imitation, fixed rehearsal or reviews being valued over performance.

20 Choice D Form, structure, and sense

The subject is the plural ceramics, which needs a plural verb. The passive construction are distinguished by completes the sentence. Is distinguished does not agree, and the other options fail to give a complete verb.

21 Choice D Boundaries

With neither or nor, the verb agrees with the nearer subject, engineers, which is plural. Was, is and has been are all singular.

22 Choice A Form, structure, and sense

The participle discovering attaches to the main clause and completes it correctly. Discovered would create a second main verb without a conjunction, she discovered would be a run-on, and and discovering breaks the parallel construction.

23 Choice B Form, structure, and sense

With two routes, the comparative less than is correct, and cost is an amount, not a count. The other options are not idiomatic.

24 Choice C Boundaries

The subject is the singular scientist; along with her colleagues is a parenthetical phrase that does not make the subject plural. The past tense presented agrees with the singular subject and the past event in March. Were presenting and have presented do not fit.

25 Choice D Boundaries

The relative pronoun must show possession of grandmother, so whose is required. Who's means who is, and whom and which do not show possession.

26 Choice A Form, structure, and sense

After had, the past participle risen is needed, and rise is intransitive so raised is wrong. Rose is the simple past, which does not follow had, and rised is not a word.

27 Choice C Transitions

The sentence draws a conclusion from the unevenness just described, so Consequently is the logical link. Instead and Likewise do not fit the relationship, and Previously refers to time.

28 Choice B Transitions

The later critics reached the opposite judgement from the early reviewers, so by contrast is the correct transition. The others suggest an example, a restatement or a consequence.

29 Choice A Transitions

The sentence sets the neglected lute against the much-studied violin, so By contrast is the logical transition.

30 Choice B Rhetorical synthesis

Scale is shown by figures for area and cost, which the first choice gives. The other choices describe the mill's history or the timing of the project without its size.

31 Choice D Rhetorical synthesis

To introduce readers to the author, the choice must name Wen Zhao and say who they are, which only the first does. The others describe the book without identifying its author.

32 Choice C Rhetorical synthesis

The goal is to explain a benefit, and only the first choice links the effect on nitrogen to the reduced need for fertiliser. The others define the practice or give half the explanation.

33 Choice A Transitions

The drought contradicts what the settlers expected, so Instead is the correct transition. Moreover and In particular add or specify, and Therefore suggests a result of the expectation.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Math, Module 1

Questions 1 to 14

1 **Choice B** Data analysis

Club 4 has 40 members and Club 3 has 18, and 40 minus 18 is 22.

2 **Choice B** Percentages

35% of 240 is 0.35 times 240, which is 84.

3 **Choice C** Linear equations

Subtracting 3x from both sides gives $2x - 12 = 10$. Adding 12 gives $2x = 22$, so $x = 11$.

4 **Choice A** Linear equations in context

The fee is paid once, so it is the constant 30. The $18 repeats each month, so it multiplies m. The total is $18m + 30$.

5 **Choice C** Systems of equations

Adding the equations gives $2x = 20$, so $x = 10$. The value 4 is y.

6 **Choice D** Functions

Each step of 1 in x adds 3 to f(x), so the slope is 3. Then $f(1) = 7$ gives $3 + 4 = 7$, so the intercept is 4.

7 **Choice B** Nonlinear expressions

Multiply the coefficients, 2 times 5 is 10, and add the exponents, 3 plus 4 is 7.

8 **Choice A** Ratios and rates

10 cups of sugar is 5 times 2 cups, so the flour is 5 times 3 cups, which is 15.

9 **Choice C** Triangles

The angles of a triangle add to 180°, so $x + 2x + 3x = 6x = 180$ and $x = 30$.

10 **Choice B** Circles

Circumference $2\pi r = 12\pi$ gives $r = 6$. The area is $\pi r^2 = 36\pi$. The value 12π is the circumference itself.

11 **Choice A** Quadratics

The equation factors as $(x - 7)(x + 2) = 0$, so $x = 7$ or $x = -2$.

12 **Choice D** Probability

40 students take the bus and 20 of them are in Grade 10, so the probability is $20/40 = 1/2$. The value 2/5 uses all 50 Grade 10 students.

13 **Choice B** Statistics

The first five scores total 400, and adding 92 gives 492. Divided by 6 the mean is 82.

14 **Choice C** Scatterplots

Substitute $x = 7$: $6(7) + 40 = 42 + 40 = 82$.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Math, Module 1

Questions 15 to 27

15 **Choice A** **Inequalities**

The total is the 45 already signed up plus 15 per week, and it must be at least 120, so the inequality is 45 + 15w ≥ 120.

16 **Choice D** **Functions**

f(3) = 2(9) − 9 + 1 = 18 − 9 + 1 = 10.

17 **Choice B** **Exponential functions**

Doubling every 3 hours means the number of doublings is t/3, so the population is 500 times 2 to the power t/3.

18 **Choice B** **Systems of equations in context**

Let a be adult tickets. Then 12a + 7(120 − a) = 1,090, so 5a + 840 = 1,090 and a = 50.

19 **Choice C** **Radicals**

Squaring both sides gives x + 7 = 25, so x = 18. The value 25 is the square of 5, not x.

20 **Choice A** **Linear functions**

The slope is (9 − 3)/(4 − 1) = 2. Using (1, 3), 3 = 2(1) + b gives b = 1.

21 **28** **Linear equations**

Let the number be n. Then (3/4)n = 21, so n = 21 times 4/3 = 28.

22 **63** **Area**

The area of a triangle is half the base times the height: (1/2)(14)(9) = 63.

23 **5** **Linear equations**

Expanding gives 2x − 6 = 3x − 11. Subtracting 2x and adding 11 gives 5 = x.

24 **30** **Percent change**

The increase is 12 dollars, and 12 divided by the original 40 is 0.30, which is 30 percent.

25 **8** **Quadratics**

The equation factors as (x − 8)(x + 2) = 0, so the solutions are 8 and −2. The positive one is 8.

26 **90** **Volume**

The volume is $\pi r^2 h = \pi(9)(10) = 90\pi$, so k = 90.

27 **12** **Right triangles**

By the Pythagorean theorem, the other leg is √(169 − 25) = √144 = 12.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Math, Module 2

Questions 1 to 14

1 **Choice D** Functions

f(4) = 3(16) − 32 + 4 = 48 − 32 + 4 = 20.

2 **Choice A** Systems of equations

Adding the equations gives 2x = 20, so x = 10.

3 **Choice C** Quadratics

The equation factors as (x − 6)(x + 8) = 0, so x = 6 or x = −8.

4 **Choice B** Percentages

20% of 160 is 0.2 times 160, which is 32.

5 **Choice D** Exponential functions

Doubling every 6 hours means the number of doublings is t/6, so the population is 300 times 2 to the power t/6.

6 **Choice C** Linear functions

The slope is (16 − 7)/(4 − 1) = 3. Using (1, 7), 7 = 3(1) + b gives b = 4.

7 **Choice A** Scatterplots

Substitute x = 8: 4(8) + 33 = 32 + 33 = 65.

8 **Choice B** Circles in the plane

The center of circle A is (4, −1). Shifting it 4 units left and 3 units down moves the center to (0, −4), and the radius is unchanged, so the equation is x2 + (y + 4)2 = 25.

9 **Choice A** Quadratics

Completing the square: $x^2 - 10x + 22 = (x - 5)^2 - 3$. The smallest value of the square is 0, so the minimum of f is −3.

10 **Choice C** Functions

g(3) = 13, so f(g(3)) = f(13) = 53. Also f(3) = 13, so g(f(3)) = g(13) = 173. The difference is 53 − 173 = −120.

11 **Choice D** Systems of equations

A system has no solution when the lines are parallel but not identical. The second equation is 4 times the left side of the first with a different constant, so a must equal 16/4 = 4.

12 **Choice B** Surface area

Each cube has 6 faces, and gluing two faces together hides 2 of the 12, leaving 10 faces of area s^2. So $10s^2 = 640$, $s^2 = 64$, and s = 8.

13 **Choice A** Circles

Arc length is the radius times the central angle in radians: 12 × π/4 = 3π.

14 **Choice C** Trigonometry

A right triangle with opposite side 5 and hypotenuse 13 has adjacent side 12, so tan A = opposite/adjacent = 5/12.

Answer explanations

SAT Practice Test 1, Math, Module 2

Questions 15 to 27

15 **Choice D** Percentages

Start at 100. After the 20% rise the price is 120, and 30% off 120 leaves 84. That is 16% lower than the original.

16 **Choice B** Absolute value

The inequality means x is within 5 of 8, so $3 \le x \le 13$. That range has 11 integers, counting both ends.

17 **Choice D** Exponential equations

Write 4 as 2^2, so the right side is 2^(2x − 6). Equal bases give x + 1 = 2x − 6, so x = 7.

18 **Choice B** Percentages

70 is 50 more than 20, and 50 / 20 = 2.5, so p = 250.

19 **Choice C** Exponential functions

A year is 12 months, so the value is multiplied by 0.7^(12/6) = 0.7^2 = 0.49 each year. That is a decrease of 1 − 0.49, or 51%.

20 **Choice A** Statistics

Multiplying by 2 multiplies the mean and the standard deviation by 2; adding 8 moves the mean by 8 but does not change the spread. The mean of A is 6.8, so the mean of B is 21.6, which is 14.8 greater. The standard deviation of B is 2 times that of A.

21 **22** Systems of equations

Adding x + y = 29 and x − y = 15 gives 2x = 44, so the larger number is 22.

22 **4** Quadratics

For $ax^2 + bx + c = 0$ the solutions add to $-b/a = -(-12)/3 = 4$.

23 **40** Similar triangles

The scale factor is DE / AB = 6 / 3 = 2. The perimeter of ABC is 20, so the perimeter of DEF is 2 × 20 = 40.

24 **4** Circles in the plane

Complete the square: $(x + 6)^2 + (y + 5)^2 = -45 + 36 + 25 = 16$. The radius is $\sqrt{16} = 4$.

25 **26** Quadratics

The maximum is at $t = -b/(2a) = 8/2 = 4$. Then $h(4) = -1(16) + 32 + 10 = 26$.

26 **10** Quadratics

Exactly one real solution means the discriminant is zero: $b^2 - 4(25) = 0$, so $b^2 = 100$ and b = 10 (taking the positive value).

27 **8** Systems with nonlinear equations

Setting the expressions equal gives $x^2 - 2x + (9 - k) = 0$. One solution means the discriminant is 0: $4 - 4(9 - k) = 0$, so k = 8.